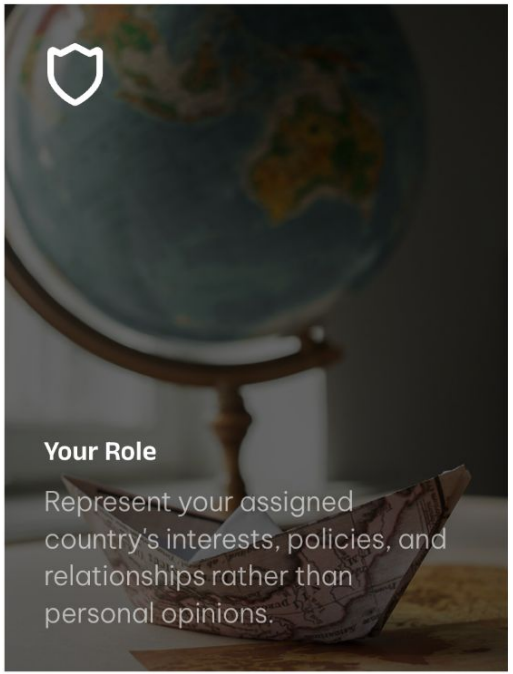


SMUN Training 2026

Model United Nations @SIS .

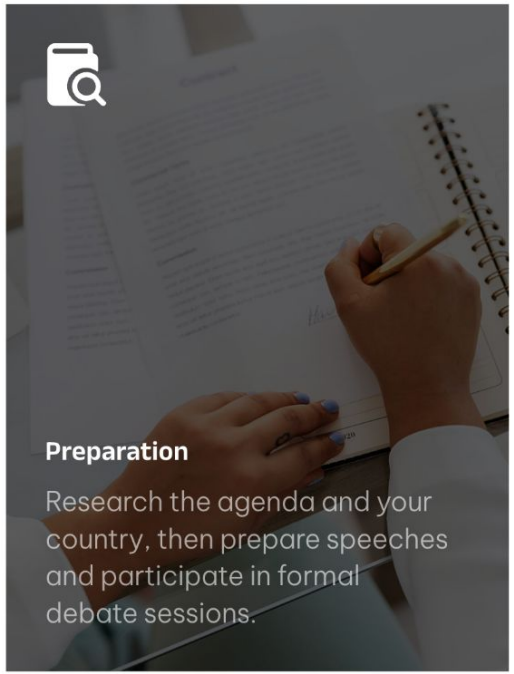
What is Model United Nations?

An academic simulation where students represent countries to discuss international issues.



Your Role

Represent your assigned country's interests, policies, and relationships rather than personal opinions.



Preparation

Research the agenda and your country, then prepare speeches and participate in formal debate sessions.

01

Negotiate & Collaborate

02

Draft & Defend Policy

“Is Being Right Enough?”

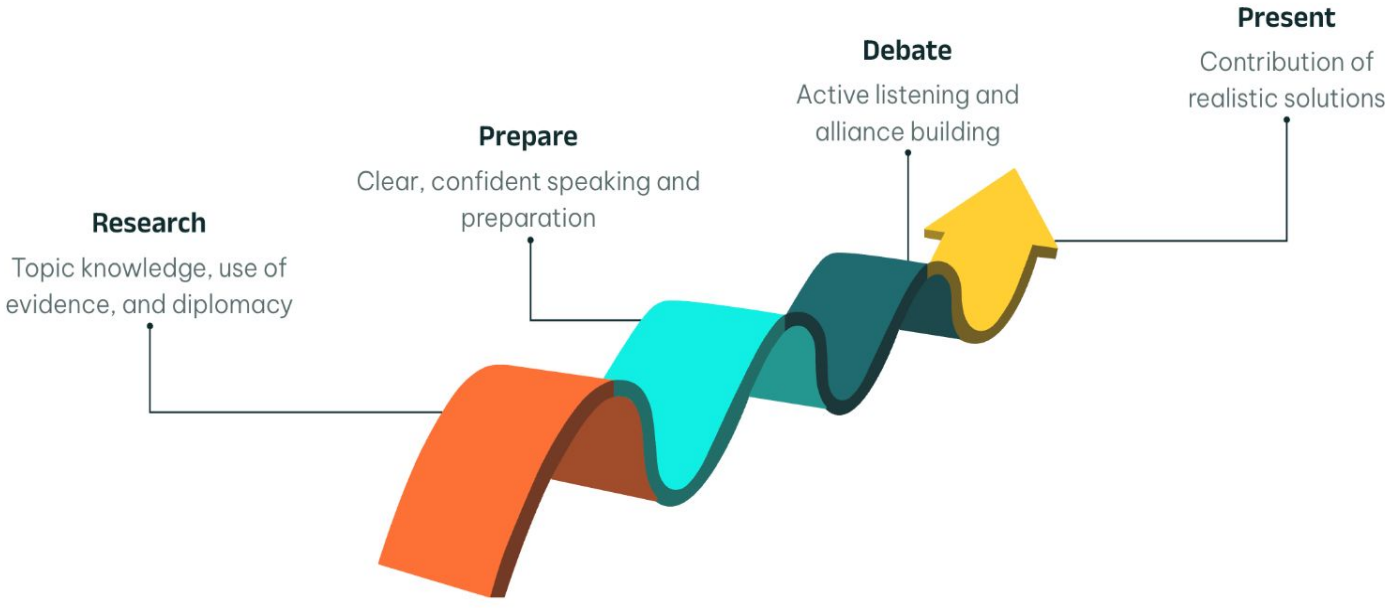
A delegate knows a lot about the agenda and has excellent facts. However, they refuse to listen to other countries, interrupt speakers and reject every compromise.

MUN Myths vs. Facts

MYTH	FACT
MUN is all serious and stressful.	Conferences are full of friendships, teamwork, and memories.
Winning an award is the only goal.	Gaining communication skills and friends is valuable.
I need to sound sophisticated.	Simple, clear arguments are often the most convincing.
You should never change your position.	Good diplomacy means listening and adapting to better solutions.
Research is boring.	Good research gives you confidence in what you are talking about.
MUN is about defeating other delegates.	MUN is about solving global problems together.
Quality beats quantity.	One well-researched speech is worth more than ten repetitive ones.

The MUN Cycle and Delegate Excellence

Success is defined by quality, evidence, and diplomatic behavior.



“What Would You Do First?”

Your committee starts tomorrow. You know your country and agenda, but you have no speech, no allies and very little research.

Quiz Link

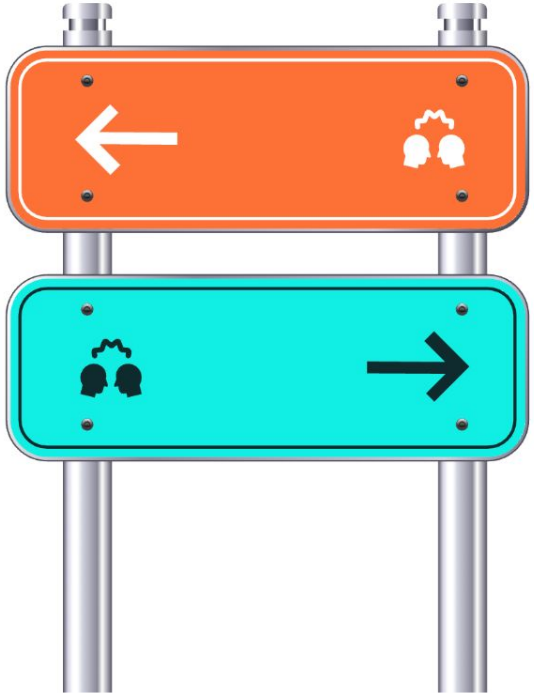
To be added:

MUN Language & Diplomacy

Delegates use formal diplomatic language and refer to peers as 'the delegation of' rather than speaking directly.

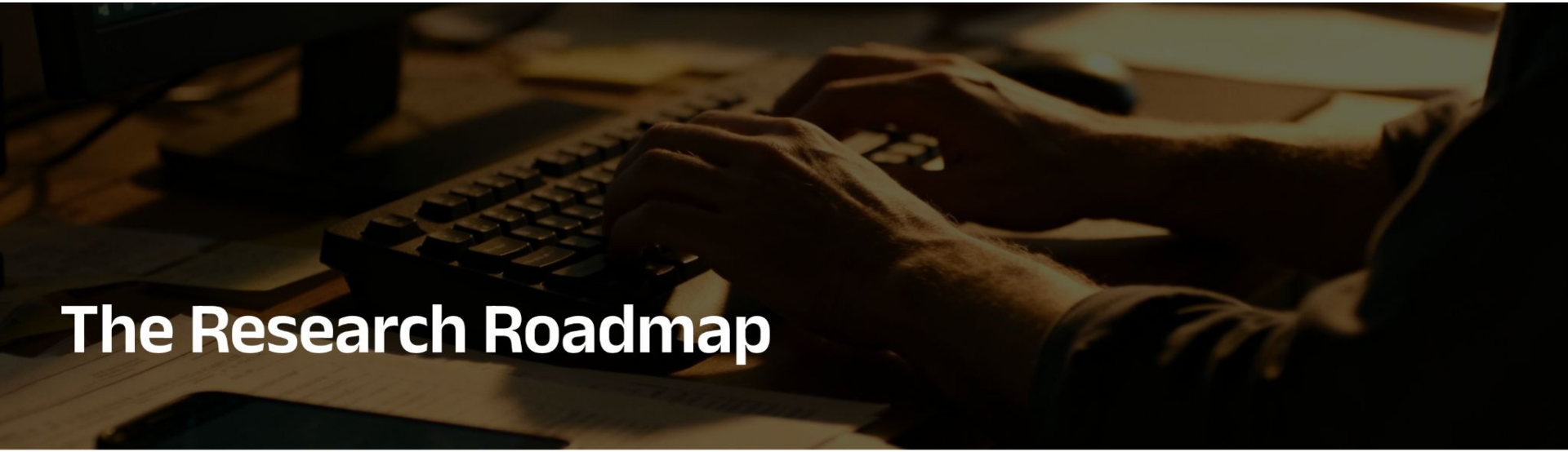
Agreeing

- 'The delegation of ___ supports this proposal.'
- 'We believe this proposal could address...'
- 'We welcome the suggestion made by...'



Disagreeing

- Use: 'The delegation of ___ respectfully disagrees' (instead of 'You are wrong').
- Use: 'The actions of ___ have contributed to this' (instead of 'Your country caused this').



The Research Roadmap

01

Understand the Country

Study demographics, systems, economy, regional allies, and UN agreements.

02

Research the Agenda

Define causes, affected parties, and review laws, treaties, and UN.

03

Verification

Analyze official statements, voting records, treaties, and reps.

“Country vs. Personal Opinion”

You personally support a particular solution, but your assigned country has different priorities and may oppose it.

Research checklist

Before MUN, you should be able to answer:

- □ What is the problem?
- □ What does my country think about it?
- □ Why does my country have this position?
- □ Who agrees with us?
- □ Who might disagree?
- □ What solutions would my committee support?
- □ What solutions would my committee oppose?

Diplomatic Language

Diplomatic does not mean weak; you can strongly disagree while remaining respectful.

Instead of	Diplomatic Alternative
Wrong	Inaccurate / questionable
Bad idea	Potentially ineffective approach
We don't agree	We respectfully disagree
You caused it	Govt actions contributed
Obviously	Important to recognize
Fix	Address
Stop	Prevent / reduce
Give money	Provide financial assistance

Diplomatic Interaction

Agreeing

"The delegation supports this proposal" or "We welcome the suggestion."

Asking Questions

"Would the delegation consider..." or "Could the delegate clarify?"

“Diplomacy or Dishonesty?”

Is diplomacy just a polite way of disagreeing?
Can a statement be diplomatic but still aggressive?
Should delegates always tell the complete truth in negotiations?
When does strategic silence become misleading?
Is it better to be blunt and honest or diplomatic and persuasive?

SPEECH PREP

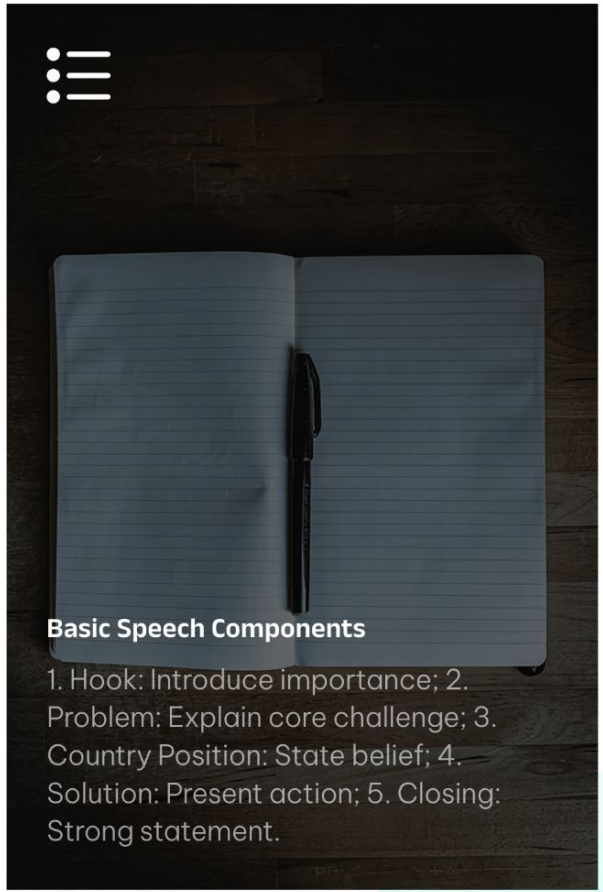
Speech Structure and Delivery

30-Second Speech

Problem → Committee → Solution

60-Second Speech

Hook → Problem → Evidence → Position → Solution → Closing



“The Speech That Changed Nothing”

A delegate gives a confident, well-delivered speech. Everyone applauds, but the speech contains no practical solution, no evidence and no clear country position.

Formal Debate: Points and Motions

Understanding procedure allows you to participate properly.

Point of Personal Privilege

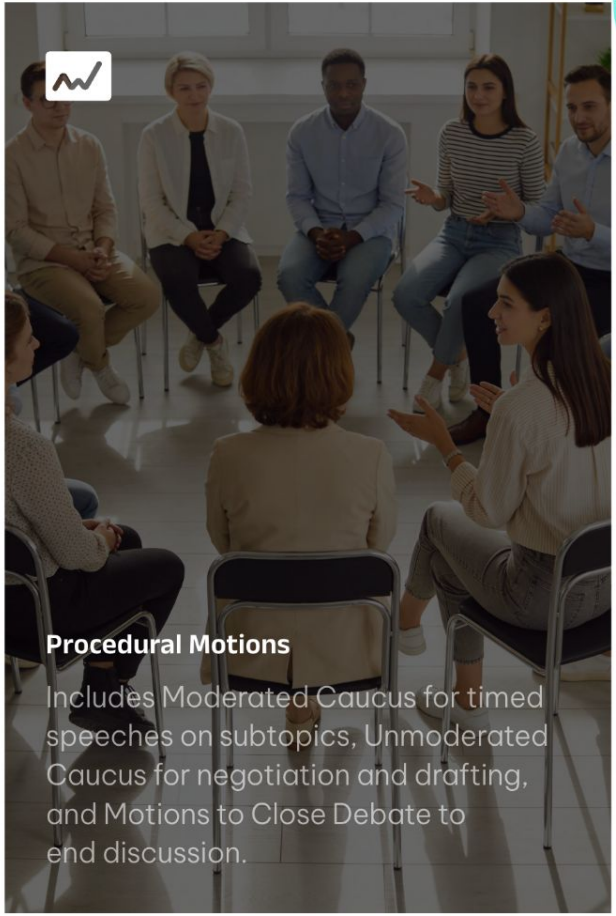
Used for issues affecting participation, like being unable to hear or see the committee proceedings.

Point of Order

Concerns specific violations of the established rules or procedure of the committee session.

A Point of Parliamentary Inquiry

Ask the Chair about parliamentary procedure, depending on the conference rules.



Procedural Motions

Includes Moderated Caucus for timed speeches on subtopics, Unmoderated Caucus for negotiation and drafting, and Motions to Close Debate to end discussion.

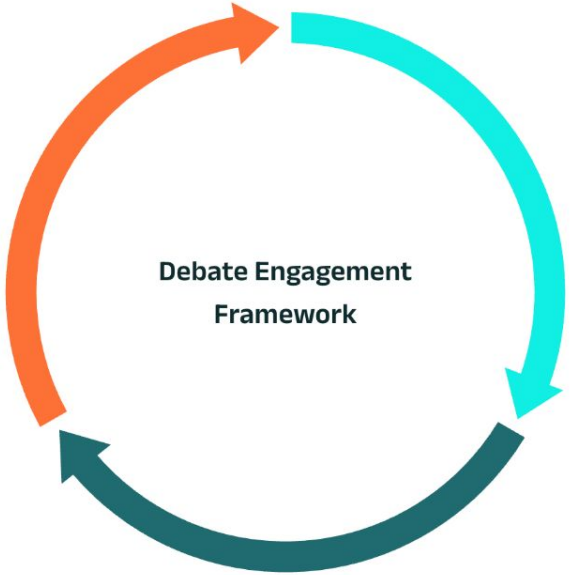
“Should the Rules Ever Get in the Way?”

An important discussion is taking place. A delegate believes the committee is wasting time on procedure, while another insists that every rule must be followed precisely.

The Art of Rebuttals and POIs

Recognize

Acknowledge opponent's argument.



Challenge

Expose gaps in logic/funding.

Replace

Offer superior alternative.

“Defend the Opposing Side”

Countries should be responsible for solving their own domestic problems

Diplomatic Response Framework

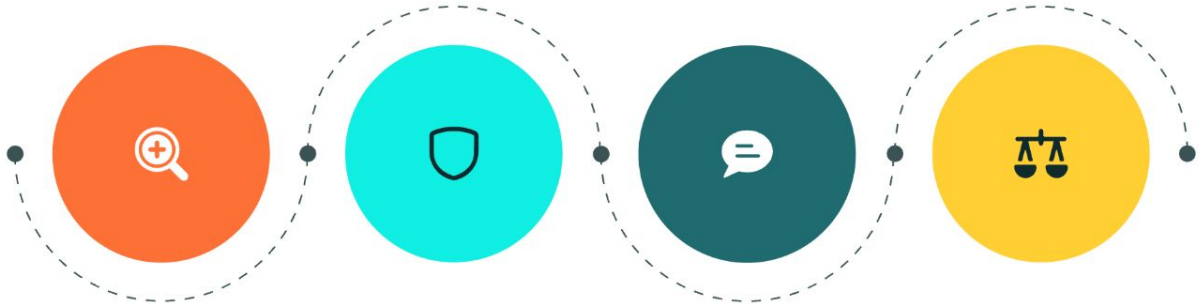
Essential techniques for handling challenging questions and maintaining composure during diplomatic interactions.

Analyze the Intent

Identify if the question challenges feasibility, funding, or core logic.

Select Response Strategy

Answer directly with evidence or request clarification if the prompt is vague.



Separate Person from Posture

Address the argument, not the person; avoid personal attacks like "they don't understand."

Handle Uncertainty

Never invent facts; pivot to what the delegation believes based on available data.



Negotiation and Alliances

MUN is a negotiation; you cannot create a strong resolution alone.

01 **Finding Allies**

Look for nations sharing similar interests, problems, or existing ties.

02 **Bloc Strategy**

Evaluate if proposals align with national policy and are realistic.

03 **The Good Negotiator**

Listens and compromises without sacrificing key national interests.

Writing Strong Resolutions

Weak Clause	Strong Clause
Encourages countries to improve education.	Encourages member states to establish teacher-training programmes through partnerships with regional educational organizations, with progress reviewed annually.

Resolution Structure

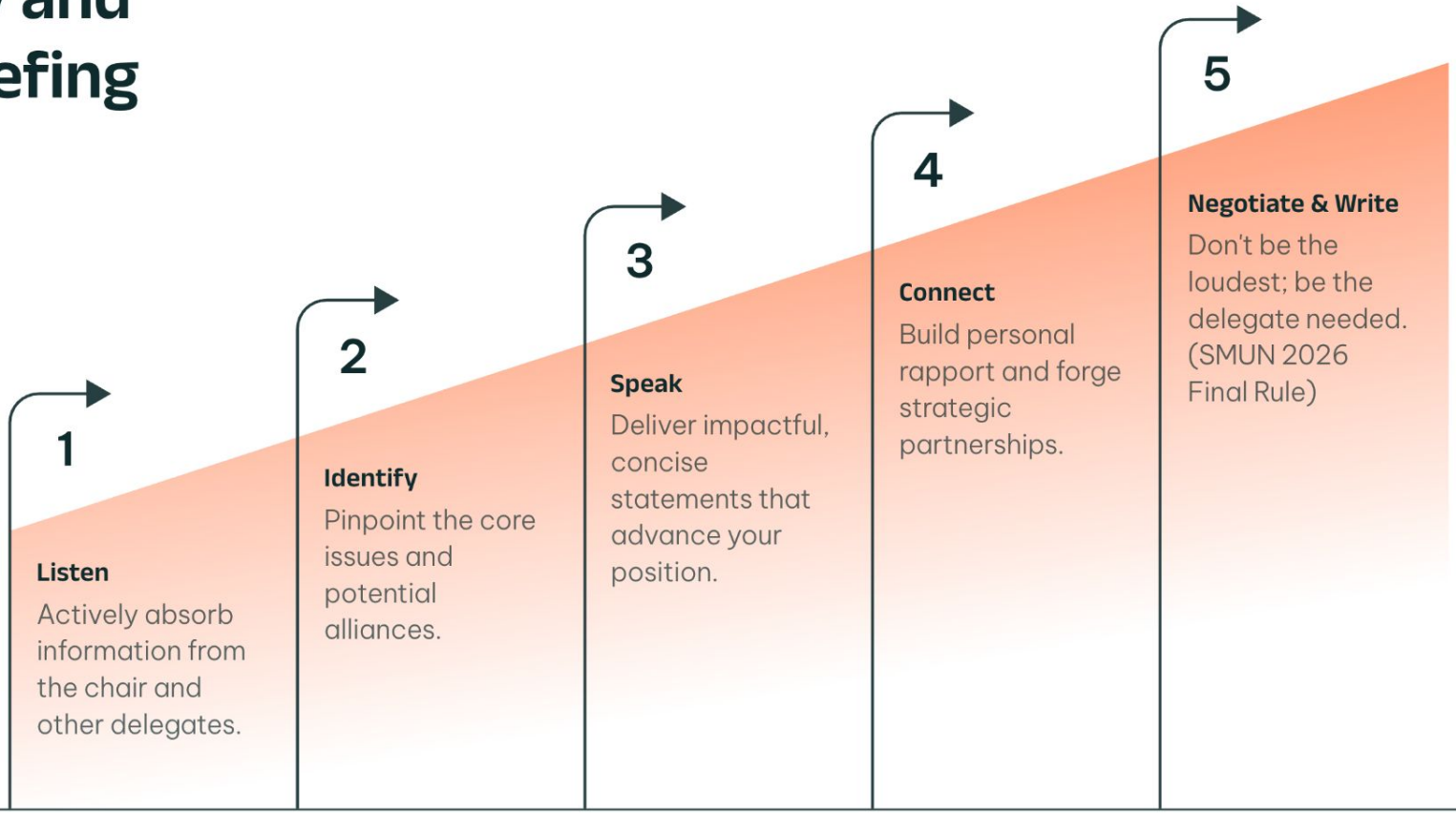
Preambulatory Clauses
Explain background, existing actions, and previous UN resolutions (Context).

Operative Clauses
Contain actual actions using verbs like: Calls upon, Encourages, Urges, Establishes.

“Would This Actually Work?”

The committee encourages all countries to end poverty as soon as possible.

Strategy and Final Briefing



What Makes a Delegate Memorable?

“Don't try to be the loudest delegate in the room. Try to be the delegate people need in the room.”

MUN should not be treated as a competition to simply speak the most.

Before committee

Prepare:

- Opening speech
- Country position
- Key statistics
- Existing policies
- Possible solutions
- Possible allies
- Questions for other countries
- Responses to likely criticism

During committee

Keep track of:
Who supports us?
Who disagrees?
What solutions are being proposed?
What information do I need?
What should I speak about next?

Don't make these mistakes
Speaking without content: A confident speech without useful information is still weak.
Using fake statistics: Never invent evidence.
Ignoring your country's position: You are a representative, not yourself.
Trying to speak constantly: Quality matters more than quantity.
Refusing every compromise: MUN requires negotiation.
Writing unrealistic solutions: Ask whether your proposal could actually be implemented.

Procedure

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1_JZcJWsoYKfGcWCDXJqPOMQoE9iu708fjPKWJab_uZ8/edit?tab=t.0

Rules of Procedure

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1DRm9-LMK6Tuq8Hvw2RaLLJpJLn4ZSK5SMRXlbeMvA6w/edit?tab=t.0

Conclusion

Quiz
Link -

Final Briefing

https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1IlpEAcqcZGs1v5F0_gWMhyuyGODtsDB9YaJhPOVPYhE/edit?slide=id.p#slide=id.p

FINAL SMUN RULE:

“Represent your country with confidence, debate with diplomacy, respect every delegate, and focus on solutions rather than winning arguments.”